

THE WHOLE METHOD, ONE PAGE

Start with one pilot. Learn fast.

A safe-to-fail pilot is a single task, bounded tightly enough that you get a clear answer in weeks, not quarters, run by your own team. The point is not to be right the first time. It is to **learn fast**, keep what works, and own it after the room empties.

HOW IT GOES · THREE MOVES, IN ORDER

01 FRAME

Write the idea as a pilot: one task, a hard boundary, a plain statement of intent. If you cannot bound it, it is not ready.

02 PRESSURE-TEST

Attack the idea, not the person. Pick it apart for what could go wrong, then rebuild it stronger. Best done on a case nobody in the room owns, so the critique stays honest.

03 ORDER

Score impact against time-to-value. The number tells you where to look first. You still make the call.

READING THE PRIORITY READOUT

The score is two numbers and a division. Rate the **value** (impact) on a 100 to 500 scale, estimate the **time to value** in weeks, then divide: **value** ÷ **weeks**. Higher means look there sooner. A 300-value pilot that pays off in 4 weeks scores 75; a 400-value pilot that takes 8 weeks scores 50, so the bigger prize still waits while the faster win compounds. It is a flashlight, not a verdict, so you make the final call.

VALUE / IMPACT

300

high impact, of 500

TIME TO VALUE

4 WEEKS

one project, one PM

LOOK HERE FIRST

75

300 ÷ 4

WHAT MAKES A PILOT SAFE

- ☐ **Small on purpose.** One task, one job, one team. Not the whole company.
- ☐ **Human checks it.** A person reviews before anything counts.
- ☐ **Built to teach.** A miss tells you something useful, fast, instead of setting you back.
- ☐ **Time-boxed.** You set the decision date before you start, so it can't drag.

START HERE

Frame one pilot.

Pick a task your team does often, the repetitive, text-heavy kind. Keep it small enough to learn from quickly. This is the one you take home.

PILOT NAME

THE TASK (WHAT IT DOES)

BOUNDARY (WHERE IT STOPS)

INTENT (THE ONE OUTCOME YOU WANT)

IS IT SAFE? · ALL FOUR, YES

☐ Happens weekly or more
 ☐ A miss would teach us, not hurt us
 ☐ We already own the data going in
 ☐ A person checks output before it counts

WHERE TO LOOK

VALUE / IMPACT (CIRCLE ONE)

HIGH

MED

LOW

TIME TO VALUE

DECISION DATE (START + 30 DAYS)

One pilot is one rep. The goal is not this task. It is the muscle to run the next ten, without anyone's help.